

We will give even greater impetus to the empowerment of weaker sections of society

- ♦ Ensure that the Bill for reserving 33% of the seats for women in the Lok Sabha and the State legislatures is passed, as a next step to the success of reservations for women in panchayats and nagarpalikas
- ♦ Endeavour to ensure that at least half of the country's rural women population is enrolled as members of self-help groups linked with banks
- ♦ Establish an Equal Opportunity Commission
- ♦ Expand social security schemes for workers in unorganized sector occupations and ensure equality of opportunity to persons with disabilities
- ♦ Provide free education at all stages – primary, secondary and university – for boys and girls belonging to dalit and adivasi communities
- ♦ Pursue affirmative action policies for SC/ST communities in the private sector
- ♦ Pay the coaching fees for entrance exams for at least one lakh SC/ST students every year

We will bring a sharp focus on the special needs of children, especially the girl child

- ♦ Ensure that the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights, which was established in 2006, continues to protect the interests of children as guaranteed by laws
- ♦ Ensure the universalisation of the Integrated Child Development Scheme (ICDS) by March 2012 and provide an anganwadi in every habitation
- ♦ Introduce special incentives for the girl child to correct the adverse sex ratio and to ensure education of girl children
- ♦ Provide monetary incentives for the girl child, in districts that have an adverse sex ratio, to be credited to the girl child's account on her completing primary, middle, secondary and higher secondary school

We will connect all villages to a broadband network in three years time

- ♦ Connect every village to a broadband network within three years. This will help locate new, non-agricultural jobs in villages and open vast new opportunities for our rural youth.

Thus the vision of Rajiv Gandhi – the use of IT for rural transformation – will be realized in even greater measure



We will give special focus to the small entrepreneur and to small and medium enterprises

- ♦ Provide a “new deal” to SMEs and for first-generation entrepreneurs, assuring them greater access to collateral-free credit, liberating them from the multiplicity of laws and forms, and freeing them from the clutches of inspectors
- ♦ Institute a targeted cluster-based approach to the growth of SMEs, by giving clusters, mostly located in small and medium towns, access to finance, technology, marketing support and infrastructure

We will maintain the path of high growth with fiscal prudence and low inflation

- ♦ Strive to maintain the growth momentum generated under the Congress-led UPA government (9% per year for the first four years of our term, achieved for the first time in India's history)
- ♦ Pursue relentless emphasis on growth that accelerates the generation of productive jobs for our youth
- ♦ Maintain high growth with low inflation, particularly in relation to prices of essential agricultural and industrial commodities
- ♦ Maintain a path of fiscal responsibility so that the ability of the Centre to invest in essential social and physical infrastructure is continuously enhanced
- ♦ Target subsidies so that it reaches only the truly needy and poor sections of our society
- ♦ Ensure that the people of India own part of the shares of public sector companies
- ♦ Support the manufacturing industry which has seen a revival in recent years, particularly labour-intensive manufacturing
- ♦ Ensure the highest standards of corporate governance in private companies, especially to protect the interests of small shareholders and small investors

